

# The 2026 Money Cheat Sheet

Every number that matters this year, on one page — the limits, phase-outs, and thresholds for tax year 2026. Each figure cites its IRS or statutory source below. No jargon, no instructions; you make the calls.

## Federal income tax brackets 2026 · TAXABLE INCOME · MARGINAL

| RATE | SINGLE                | MARRIED FILING JOINTLY | HEAD OF HOUSEHOLD     |
|------|-----------------------|------------------------|-----------------------|
| 10%  | \$0 – \$12,400        | \$0 – \$24,800         | \$0 – \$17,700        |
| 12%  | \$12,401 – \$50,400   | \$24,801 – \$100,800   | \$17,701 – \$67,450   |
| 22%  | \$50,401 – \$105,700  | \$100,801 – \$211,400  | \$67,451 – \$105,700  |
| 24%  | \$105,701 – \$201,775 | \$211,401 – \$403,550  | \$105,701 – \$201,750 |
| 32%  | \$201,776 – \$256,225 | \$403,551 – \$512,450  | \$201,751 – \$256,200 |
| 35%  | \$256,226 – \$640,600 | \$512,451 – \$768,700  | \$256,201 – \$640,600 |
| 37%  | Over \$640,600        | Over \$768,700         | Over \$640,600        |

Standard deduction: **\$16,100** single · **\$32,200** joint · **\$24,150** head of household. Brackets are marginal — only the income inside each band is taxed at that rate. Long-term capital gains: 0% rate up to **\$49,450** taxable income single · **\$98,900** joint · **\$66,200** head of household.

## Retirement & health account limits 2026 · CONTRIBUTION

| ACCOUNT                                         | UNDER 50          | CATCH-UP, 50+ | INCOME PHASE-OUT (MAGI)                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 401(k) · 403(b) · most 457 · TSP                | \$24,500          | +\$8,000      | n/a · ages 60–63: catch-up is \$11,250 instead, if your plan allows |
| Roth IRA                                        | \$7,500           | +\$1,100      | \$153,000 – \$168,000 single/HoH · \$242,000 – \$252,000 joint      |
| Traditional IRA (deduction, if covered at work) | \$7,500           | +\$1,100      | \$81,000 – \$91,000 single · \$129,000 – \$149,000 joint            |
| HSA — self-only / family                        | \$4,400 / \$8,750 | —             | n/a · requires a qualifying high-deductible plan                    |
| Health FSA                                      | \$3,400           | —             | n/a                                                                 |

The IRA limit is shared between Roth and Traditional — one **\$7,500** total, not each. High earners: if your 2025 wages from that employer topped **\$150,000**, any 2026 catch-up in that plan must go in as Roth.

## Thresholds worth knowing 2026 · WHAT CHANGED IS MARKED

- Child Tax Credit: **\$2,200** per child (up to \$1,700 refundable) **RAISED**
  - Annual gift exclusion: **\$19,000** per recipient, per giver
  - Student loan interest: deduct up to **\$2,500** (phases out \$85,000–\$100,000 single/HoH · \$175,000–\$205,000 joint)
  - CTC phase-out: starts at **\$400,000** joint · **\$200,000** other (credit falls \$50 per \$1,000 of MAGI above)
  - Dependent care FSA: **\$7,500** household · **\$3,750** MFS (up from \$5,000/\$2,500 — only if your employer's plan adopts it) **RAISED**
- Quarterly estimates: generally required if you'll owe **\$1,000+** after withholding and refundable credits
  - 1099-NEC threshold: **\$2,000+** (the \$600 rule is gone) **CHANGED**
  - Business mileage: **72.5¢** Jan–Jun, **76¢** Jul–Dec (changed mid-year) **CHANGED**
  - Self-employment tax: **15.3%** on 92.35% of net profit (owed once net earnings reach \$400)
  - HSA catch-up, 55+: **+\$1,000** on top of the contribution limits above (self-only or family, either way)

### Three five-minute gap checks

- 1 **Find your gap.** Circle the bracket your taxable income lands in and write down the dollars left before the next line.

2 **Room remaining.** Add up what you've put into your 401(k), IRA, and HSA so far this year. Write each next to its limit above. The difference is room. 401(k) room closes December 31; IRA and HSA room for 2026 stays open until April 15, 2027.

3 **Phase-out check.** Circle every range on this page your income lands inside — Roth, Traditional deduction, student loan interest. Inside a range means the rule is partially yours; that's worth knowing before year-end.

**Figures checked September 2026 against:** IRS Rev. Proc. 2025-32 (brackets, standard deduction, capital gains, Child Tax Credit amount, student loan interest, 1099-NEC threshold, gift exclusion, Health FSA) · IRS Notice 2025-67 (401(k), IRA, catch-ups, IRA phase-outs) · IRS Rev. Proc. 2025-19 (HSA) · IR-2025-128 and IR-2026-29 (mileage) · IRS Form 1040-ES (quarterly estimated-payment threshold, self-employment tax rate) · 26 U.S.C. §24(b) (Child Tax Credit phase-out), §223(b)(3)(B) (HSA catch-up), §129(a)(2)(A) as amended by OBBBA (dependent care FSA), §6017 (self-employment tax filing threshold), via uscode.house.gov. Federal only; states differ. · diy-wealth-framework.vercel.app

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